

Course Engagement Scorecard

A Self-Evaluation Instrument for Course Creators

3 DOMAINS | 9 INDICATORS | 18 POINTS POSSIBLE

HOW TO USE THIS SCORECARD

Score each indicator using the 0-1-2 scale on each page.

0 = Red Flag: This is not present or is working against you.

1 = Partial: This exists but is inconsistent or underdeveloped.

2 = Solid: This is clearly present and working well.

Use whole numbers only. When uncertain, score down.

Add your scores at the end of each domain and record your total.

DOMAIN 1: ENGAGEMENT ARCHITECTURE

Engagement Architecture is the invisible structure that pulls learners through your course. These three indicators reveal whether your course is designed to hold attention or designed to lose it.

1.1. Opening Hook

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

The first lesson opens with credentials, a welcome, or an overview of what is covered.

The first lesson mentions a problem the learner has, but does not make it feel urgent or personal.

The first lesson opens with a specific conflict, provocative question, or stakes that make the learner feel they cannot afford to stop watching.

My score for 1.1: circle one:

0**1****2**

1.2. Lesson Pacing Variation

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

Every lesson follows the same format and delivery speed. There is no variation in how content is presented.

Occasionally the format changes, but it feels accidental rather than deliberate. Pacing is mostly uniform.

Lessons deliberately vary format, speed, and activity type. The learner cannot predict exactly what is coming next.

My score for 1.3: circle one:

0**1****2**

1.9. Progress Recognition

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

The course does not acknowledge when learners complete milestones or modules. Progress is invisible.

There is a completion indicator or congratulatory message, but it feels automated and generic.

The course marks meaningful progress points in a way that feels earned and specific to what the learner just accomplished.

My score for 1.9: circle one:

0**1****2****DOMAIN 1 SCORE:**

/ 6

5-6: Strong | 3-4: Developing | needs significant attention

DOMAIN 4: STORYTELLING AND ABSTRACTION

The difference between content people remember and content they forget almost always comes down to storytelling and concreteness. These three indicators reveal whether your course teaches in ways the brain can hold.

4.1. Abstraction Level

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

Concepts are explained in abstract or theoretical language throughout. Examples are hypothetical and general.

Some concrete examples appear, but they are not specific enough to be memorable. The pattern is inconsistent.

Every abstract concept is paired with a concrete, specific example. The learner can picture a real situation, not a category.

My score for 4.1: circle one:

0

1

2

4.2. Named Characters in Examples

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

Examples use "someone" or "a person" or "many learners." No specific named character is used.

Occasionally a name is used, but the character is not developed enough to feel real or memorable.

Examples consistently use named characters in specific situations. The learner follows the same character across multiple examples.

My score for 4.2: circle one:

0

1

2

4.4. Struggle Recognition

0: RED FLAG**1: PARTIAL****2: SOLID**

The course does not acknowledge that learners might find the material difficult or confusing at certain points.

The course occasionally says something is hard, but does not normalize the struggle or provide a path through it.

The course anticipates where learners will struggle, names it specifically, and reframes it as a normal and useful part of learning.

My score for 4.4: circle one:

0

1

2

DOMAIN 4 SCORE: / 65-6: Strong | 3-4: Developing | needs significant attention

DOMAIN 6: COURSE STRUCTURE AND HOOKS

Structure is what transforms a collection of lessons into a course someone wants to finish. These three indicators reveal whether your course has a narrative spine or is just organized information.

6.1 Conflict Definition

0: RED FLAG

1: PARTIAL

2: SOLID

The course does not establish a central conflict or problem that the entire course is built to resolve.

A problem is mentioned in the introduction but not woven into the course structure. It disappears after Lesson 1.

The course is built around a single, clearly named conflict that every module and lesson connects back to.

My score for 6.1: circle one:

0

1

2

6.2 The Big Idea

0: RED FLAG

1: PARTIAL

2: SOLID

There is no single memorable idea the learner is meant to take away. The course is a collection of topics.

A central idea is implied but never stated in a way the learner could repeat to someone else.

The course has one big idea stated clearly and early. The learner could explain it in one sentence by the end of Lesson 1.

My score for 6.2: circle one:

0

1

2

6.3 Lesson Level Hooks

0: RED FLAG

1: PARTIAL

2: SOLID

Individual lessons begin with a title card or recap of the previous lesson. There is no reason to keep watching.

Some lessons begin with a question or preview, but it is inconsistent and not designed to create forward momentum.

Every lesson opens with a hook in the first 30 seconds that creates a specific reason to watch through to the end.

My score for 6.3: circle one:

0

1

2

DOMAIN 6 SCORE:

/ 6

5-6: Strong | 3-4: Developing | needs significant attention

YOUR TOTAL SCORECARD SCORE

DOMAIN	YOUR SCORE	MAX	PERCENTAGE
Domain 1: Engagement Architecture		6	
Domain 4: Storytelling and Abstraction		6	
TOTAL SCORE		18	

READING YOUR SCORE

- 15-18

Strong across these three domains. Your course has solid structural bones in the areas covered here.
- 10-14

Developing. Meaningful gaps exist. Prioritize the indicators you scored 0 first.
- 5-9

Significant design issues are present. These are costing you completions and sales.
- 0-4

Foundational work is needed before marketing or pricing changes will make a difference.

WHAT I NOTICED:

You have just scored 3 of 8 domains.

The full 8-Domain Diagnostic Blueprint covers all 172 indicators across all eight domains, with scoring rubrics, insight boxes, failure pattern analysis, and a Priority Action Planner. It is the complete instrument for diagnosing exactly what to fix and in what order.